

NON-BINDING PROPOSAL

DATA PIPELINE & COSTING INTELLIGENCE

A staged offer for turning fragmented THA costing knowledge into traceable costing-intelligence workflows.

Client: Thomas Hillig Architects **Date:** 22.06.2026 **Prepared by:** FORMATION GmbH

THA's costing problem spans fragmented historical data, industry standards, local factors, THA labour, carbon impact, and contractor dependencies.

The goal is to reduce costing cycle time in early project stages, make assumptions and design alternatives more transparent, and reduce dependence on external costing specialists where the work can be handled internally with confidence.

1. PROBLEM

Costing is too slow and often depends on external specialists or contractor inputs. The returned work can still be incomplete, which creates risk in early project decisions and client-facing estimates.

THA's costing knowledge is highly domain-specific and fragmented across spreadsheets, project documents, historical cost information, Projo exports, contractor inputs, labour assumptions, and paper records.

2. WORKING HYPOTHESIS

A THA costing intelligence knowledge base can support faster, more transparent, and more reusable costing work by combining AI-supported workflows with THA's own data.

LAYER	WHAT IT BRINGS TOGETHER	WHY IT MATTERS
Data foundation	Spreadsheets, project documents, historical costs, Projo exports, external examples, contractor inputs.	Creates a usable basis for estimation and comparison.
Costing structure	Materials, amounts, DIN 276 categories, labour, regional variation, overhead assumptions.	Supports repeatable and explainable costing logic.
Review controls	Trusted source rules, confidence, assumption visibility, human review, hand-offs.	Keeps professional judgement in control.

3. PHASE PLAN

PHASE	CORE WORK	DURATION
Startup	Discovery workshop, job shadowing, data audit, gap analysis, scope, risks, and success criteria.	2 weeks
De-risking / experimentation	Vertical slice using limited representative data to test ingestion, mapping, traceability, labour assumptions, and carbon logic.	3 weeks
Prototyping & testing	First testable solution around the highest-value use case, including demos and workshop feedback.	6 weeks
Early validation / pilot	Pilot and calibration on real or near-real costing work, compared against historical estimates and expert judgement.	6 weeks
Wider validation / rollout	Broader workflow integration across more projects, data sources, and recurring costing needs.	8 weeks
Robustness & full adoption	Stress tests, edge cases, permissions, audit trail, QA process, and team training.	6 weeks

4. GUARDRAILS

The solution should not be treated as a fully automatic black box. Costing is commercially sensitive and project-specific, so the workflows need clear guardrails.

REQUIRED CONTROLS

- Trusted data-source definitions
- Visible assumptions and confidence levels
- Source traceability for estimates

REVIEW MODEL

- Human review before sensitive outputs are used
- Clear hand-offs inside THA's process
- Calibration against real examples and expert judgement

5. COSTING

STARTUP

EUR 20k

2 weeks.

DE-RISKING

EUR 20k

3 weeks.

FULL ADOPTION PATH

EUR 230k

Estimated total through
phase 6.

Phase cost estimates are based on the current understanding and can be revised if scope materially increases or decreases. Expansion is ongoing and costed separately as support or later scope extension.

Additional effort is billed at EUR 2k per day. Operational costs such as LLM tokens and hosting are covered directly by THA. THA also directly covers any required digitisation of paper or other records deemed necessary.

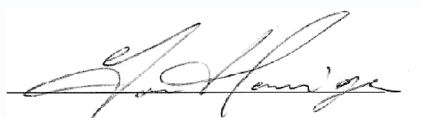
6. NEXT STEP

Align on participants, sample material, and the startup-phase workshop format.

Recommended start

Approve the EUR 20k startup phase.

YOURS SINCERELY,



Ian Hannigan

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